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Top Skills

Board of Directors
Startups
Executive Management

Steven Hertzberg

Architecting for Complexity | Decentralized Ventures | Capital Markets | Aerospace Engineer | 35yrs of Startups | Former DOD | Unsolicited DM Pitches will be Ignored.
Ponte Vedra Beach, Florida, United States

Summary

GOAL: Architect Systems that Thrive in Complexity.

SUMMARY: Business schools do not teach how to design business models that grow stronger in deeply volatile times. Steven's deep understanding of network science and systems offers existing business and new startup ventures unique insights not found elsewhere.

HISTORY: An aerospace engineer by education, Steven has over 30 years of start-up company experience as an engineer, business strategist & management team member across various industry sectors, including: military & defense; manufacturing; medical systems; food production; Internet technologies, advertising & financial services.

Steven spent the early part of his career as a civilian in systems engineering & project management, designing & managing major aircraft programs for the U.S. Navy, Marines & Army. He received the Civilian Special Act Award for his work as a test director on the APACHE Helicopter development program.

After decades of studying cybernetics & complex systems, Steven now invests his time developing totally new business models designed to become highly reflexive complex adaptive systems across a self-organizing network.

CURRENT: Steven began his focus on decentralized architectures in 2013, applying his experience in complex systems, social networks & startup ventures through the Silicon Valley Collaboratory - a small San Francisco incubator he started in 2010. Steven now makes himself available to decentralized startups with big ideas & big TAMs who wish to totally re-imagine the sectors they target.

Steven is currently focused on increasing access to wealth creation from the developing world to the first world. But his overarching goal is deploying autopoietic systems that positively impact humanity.

CRYPTOGRAPHY: Steven has a long history in cryptography, designing a system to employ PGP across a former military communications network to securely transmit medical patient data. Steven's original cryptographic keys remain on the MIT KEY SERVER (http://pgp.mit.edu):

Sep 1996
pub 1024R/E214D36D

BANNER PHOTO: Pictured above are some of the attendees of the famous Macy Conferences (mid 1900's) - the minds that laid the foundational science for our current Technocracy.

# # #

PERSONAL INTERESTS: complexity, conversation theory, gordon pask, heinz von foerster, norbert wiener, alex pentland, ross ashby, kurt gödel, manuel delanda, stafford beer, Warren McCulloch, walter pitts, Claude Shannon, john von neumann, jacques ellul, macy conferences, hedging, speculating, blockchain, bitcoin, BTC, ethereum.

Experience

Outcome Labs Ltd
Board Member
April 2022 - Present (3 years 5 months)
Cayman Islands

Outcome Trading DAO is a decentralized network that makes derivatives trading so easy anyone can do it.

Currently, derivatives are a highly centalized quadrillion-dollar industry (notional value) typically only available to very large stakeholders trading commodities at enormous volumes. Outcome will extend the benefits of

derivatives to unserved markets across the globe (where regulations allow), enabling small producers to affordably protect prices of key inputs and resources (e.g. energy, metals, petrochemicals, agriculture, digital assets), while allowing investors to more safely speculate on an ever expanding array of commodities.

Note: Outcome Labs Ltd is the operating entity for the Outcome Trading DAO.

Wicked Labs
Strategic Advisor to Decentralized Startups
April 2023 - Present (2 years 5 months)

Helping decentralized startup ventures re-imagine traditional models. I can help unpack and apply Jim Collins', "Built to Last" (1994), message to the Amazon executive team (2001): "In times like this you want to respond not by reacting to bad news, but by building a flywheel." Tap into my decades of study into complex adaptive systems and network science to build your own decentralized flywheel.

Feel free to DM me.

A WICKED PROBLEM is one that is difficult or impossible to solve because it involves multiple elements that are often changing, or incomplete and contradictory. It cannot be readily fixed or solved, because there is usually no single solution.

In THE RISE OF WICKED PROBLEMS—UNCERTAINTY, COMPLEXITY AND DIVERGENCE, Rittel and Webber argued that scientific and technocratic approaches for tackling the difficult issues are inadequate. Science and engineering approaches produce reliable knowledge but are appropriate only for technical issues where the key variables are measurable, and optimal solutions can be agreed. These are the ‘tame’ or ‘benign’ problems, with clear boundaries and agreed solutions. By contrast, modern problems are ‘wicked’ problems, because stakeholders disagree about the nature of these problems, about possible solutions, and about the values or principles that should guide improvements.

In WICKED PROBLEMS AND THE CYBERNETIC METHOD, A. Pickering argues that the world is full of wicked problems, problems that resist a priori scientific solutions. So how can we address them, engage with them and even solve them? The answer must entail a sort of practical experimentation

extended over time—acting on the system in question, seeing what it does, adapting to that, and so on, in a process he refers to as a dance of agency.

The Gödel Foundation

Executive Director

December 2022 - Present (2 years 9 months)

My personal contribution to support causes that strengthen American democratic institutions.

The foundation is named after Kurt Gödel, a Princeton Institute fellow who was one of the principal founders of the modern, metamathematical era in mathematical logic. He is widely known for his Incompleteness Theorems, which are among the handful of landmark theorems in twentieth century mathematics, but his work touched every field of mathematical logic. Some background....

In 1928 Hilbert and Ackermann publicly released a set of questions regarding mathematics as part of a publication called Principia Mathematica. One of the questions posed addressed a concept called completeness. In response, a young Gödel published two theorems that concern the limits of provability in formal axiomatic theories.

The first Incompleteness Theorem states that in any consistent formal system there are statements which can neither be proved nor disproved from within said system. In summary, this means that there are arithmetical statements (ie formulas) that are true, but not provable.

According to the second Incompleteness Theorem, a formal system cannot prove its own consistency (assuming it is consistent).

Jon von Neumann, the famous computer scientist, wrote to Gödel on 20 November 1930 saying "I have recently concerned myself again with logic, using the methods you have employed so successfully in order to exhibit undecidable propositions. In doing so I achieved a result that seems to me to be remarkable. Namely, I was able to show that the consistency of mathematics is unprovable." On 29 November 1930 von Neumann went further, writing "I think that your result has solved negatively the foundational question: there is no rigorous justification for classical mathematics."

Grey Swan Digital

Co-Founder
May 2015 - December 2022 (7 years 8 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Grey Swan is launching the Price Sharing Economy, which takes the global derivatives industry and makes it accessible to everyone. Through an innovative worldwide network exchanges, participants from an developing world farmer to a Community banker to a Silicon Valley startup can easily trade or hedge the price of any underlying asset, anywhere.

Silicon Valley Collaboratory
Founder
January 2010 - April 2022 (12 years 4 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Founder of an incubator integrating lessons from bleeding-edge military doctrine into startup technology companies.

Startups include:
Grey Swan Markets, a digital marketplace for real estate risk; Grey Swan Technologies, microtechnology services for FinTech.

Heart Mountain Group
Founder
July 2008 - October 2010 (2 years 4 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Developed business models and designed market entrance strategies for technology startups.

Startups include:
KarmaCoverage, a P2P property insurance network; Gratooity, a consumer-hospitality worker network; OpenSilo, an enterprise communications platform; Verlatus, a retail-consumer trust platform; cQuity, an equity for services exchange; CoEngineers, a professional civil engineering marketplace.

Election Science Institute
Founder
January 2001 - October 2008 (7 years 10 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Founder of a national, non-partisan, non-profit social network designed to crowdsource quantifiable election data in order to measure the performance of the US election system in real time.

Key documents archived at https://votewatch.wordpress.com/

Cyberplex
Managing Director
July 2000 - May 2003 (2 years 11 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Identified leads, closed sales, managed accounts, developed relationships with C-level execs, and expanded revenues for Canadian-based digital professional services firm, offering marketing, enterprise-level system design and development to Silicon Valley technology companies.

Amniventure, LLC
Founder
July 1999 - September 2001 (2 years 3 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Developed business models and designed market entrance strategies for technology startups.

Startups include:
MyPersonal.com, one of the first social networks, serving US college alumni; QOOL.com, an early entrant into affiliate and incentive-based online marketing.

CyberCapital
Founder
January 1998 - June 1999 (1 year 6 months)
Australia

Founder of a micro-venture capital firm that conducted the first web-based IPO outside the United States, working with the Australian Securities Commissions in order to ensure regulatory compliance.

Australian Medical Network
Founder
October 1995 - December 1997 (2 years 3 months)
Australia

Founder of the first technology company that enabled medical practitioners to electronically file insurance claims via encrypted containers with government processing systems, facilitating secure, prompt, accurate and inexpensive medical claim fulfillment.

DRTV Down Under, Pty Ltd
Founder
March 1993 - August 1995 (2 years 6 months)
Australia

Founder of a direct response television network in Australia, grossing approximately $140K per episode with gross margins of 30-35%.

Resorts & Great Hotels
Director Of Business Development
January 1992 - January 1993 (1 year 1 month)
Southern California

Responsible for building relationships and generating sales at exclusive properties across the South Pacific, Australia and New Zealand.

ZPI
Co-Founder
March 1989 - March 1992 (3 years 1 month)
Southern California

Co-Founder of an automobile accessories manufacturer and wholesale marketing company.

Food Tools
Director Of Business Development
January 1990 - January 1992 (2 years 1 month)
Southern California

Part of a four-person management team. Created a sales strategy and led the initial sales of computer-automated baking equipment for large-scale industrial bakery assembly lines in the Asia/Pacific region.

Naval Air Systems Command (NAVAIR)
Program Manager
June 1986 - October 1989 (3 years 5 months)
Washington D.C. Metro Area

Project Director in charge of development and operations of everything the Navy and Marine Aircrew wore from the neck up, including head-mounted night vision, motion detection & targeting, infrared sighting and the first noise reduction systems.

Challenger Space Shuttle Memorial Scholarship Fund
Founder
January 1986 - May 1986 (5 months)

Purdue University

Founded fund that continues to provide scholarships to Purdue University students studying Aerospace Engineering.

US Army Apache Helicopter Development Program

Project Manager and Test Director

May 1982 - August 1985 (3 years 4 months)

St Louis

Youngest project manager on the APACHE Helicopter development team. Directly responsible for the testing of the aircraft's remote base support facility (at Fort Huachuca, Arizona).

Education

School of Aeronautics and Astronautics, Purdue University

BSAAE, Aerospace Engingeering · (1981 - 1986)